THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · MEDIUM LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 5: **Universal Franchise and India's Electoral System** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Universal franchise promotes equality because 1

(a) rich votes count more **(b)** the educated vote

(c) every vote has the same value **(d)** men vote only

2. Voter apathy weakens democracy because 1

(a) all vote **(b)** more people vote

(c) fewer people decide the leaders **(d)** none vote

3. Which reform made elections more transparent? 1

(a) Proxy voting **(b)** Cash gifts

(c) Voter ID cards and EVMs **(d)** Delay in counting

4. Why is it important that the ECI is independent? 1

(a) It writes laws **(b)** It can favour the ruling party

(c) It decides courts **(d)** It can run impartial elections

5. Money power harms elections by 1

(a) helping poor

(b) giving unfair advantage to rich candidates

(c) ending parties

(d) reducing campaigns

6. Which is correct about the Lok Sabha? 1

(a) It is indirectly elected **(b)** It has 12 nominated members

(c) It is directly elected for five years **(d)** It is permanent

7. A candidate wins a seat with 30% of the votes in a contest among many candidates. This is possible under 1

(a) First-Past-the-Post

(b) a two-round run-off system

(c) a rule requiring 50% of registered voters

(d) a rule requiring an absolute majority

8. Why did India's decision to grant universal franchise at once stand out? 1

(a) Many countries gave voting rights in stages
(b) It excluded women
(c) No one else voted
(d) It excluded poor

9. The 'majority' needed to form a government in the Lok Sabha is 1

(a) more than half of the seats **(b)** all seats
(c) one-fourth **(d)** one seat

10. An indirect election is one in which 1

(a) judges vote
(b) the people vote directly
(c) no one votes
(d) representatives elect other representatives

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why must the ECI be independent? 2

12. How does NOTA help voters? 2

13. Why is the Rajya Sabha called permanent? 2

14. How does FPTP differ from majority rule? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Explain why universal franchise is a key feature of democracy. 3

16. Describe the problems of money and muscle power. 3

17. Why are reserved constituencies necessary? 3

OR

Compare direct and indirect elections. 3

18. Explain how technology improved elections. 3

OR

How do elections help in making governments accountable? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Discuss how universal franchise has strengthened Indian democracy. 5

OR

Explain how inclusivity is ensured in voting for the disabled and elderly. 5

20. Explain the structure, independence and powers of the ECI. 5

OR

Describe the three tiers of elections and why each matters. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks